Dimitri Lesas

Co-Founder & Founding Engineer • AI Products & Platforms • SC Cleared

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Profile

Co-founder and founding engineer with 8 years in data and AI, building AI products from first commit to production. Previously led AI delivery for the Royal Navy and UK national security.

Professional Experience

Co-Founder & Founding Engineer **Nov 2025 – Present**

Felix Research · AI research platform for financial analysts

- Co-founded the company, set much of the product direction and built most of its 10+ services: the AI pipeline, all AWS infrastructure, the database schema and much of the frontend.
- Live in production within 3 months: used by 4 businesses, with 500,000+ pages processed.
- Pitched to 12+ investors, including at conferences, and fielded their technical questions.
- Self-host all AI models on an auto-scaling 50+ GPU cluster: sub-second inference, zero idle cost.
- Cut GPU cold starts from 5+ minutes to ~30 s using CRIU and cuda-checkpoint snapshots.
- Brought GPU processing cost to ~$0.03 per page (about a tenth of the list price), cut idle database load by 75%, and run the whole platform, GPUs included, for under $2k a month.
- Designed a privacy-first architecture with a separate database for every customer organisation; lead the technical side of 3 compliance programmes: SOC 2, ISO 27001 and GDPR.
- Lead engineering hiring for the founding team, running technical interviews for candidates.

Senior Full Stack Engineer & Data Scientist **Dec 2023 – Nov 2025**

Capita · Defence technology for the Royal Navy

- Partnered directly with Royal Navy stakeholders to design, develop and deploy a full-stack AI application on the Palantir Foundry platform, serving 500+ personnel.
- Owned the end-to-end system design, including Spark pipelines processing hundreds of GB daily.
- Mentored 5 engineers bi-weekly across frontend and data engineering.
- Delivered automation saving 5 days a month; commended at the Rear Admiral's annual address.

Machine Learning Engineer **Jun 2022 – Dec 2023**

Roke · Defence and national security R&D

- Tech lead on 3 long-term cross-functional projects delivering national security systems.
- Built and deployed a novel image-to-image GAN from scratch: real-time video at 99% accuracy.
- Integrated 4 databases (time-series, columnar, geospatial, graph) ingesting 20–30 GB daily.
- Published a Roke paper on hyperdimensional computing; supervised 3 Russell Group MSc theses.

Senior Data Science Consultant **Nov 2020 – May 2022**

Capita · Data consultancy for public and private sector clients

- Led the customer-facing build of a global carbon reporting platform covering 7,905 cost centres, enabling a 30% CO_2 reduction in one year; the customer's primary technical contact.
- Managed a team of 5 and mentored 7 engineers bi-weekly across two teams.
- Presented to C-level and non-technical stakeholders, achieving a 60% client contract extension rate.

Earlier Experience **2018 – 2022**

- Freelance ML Engineer, Equestrian Performance Analysis: built the entire pose-estimation AI pipeline (YOLOv3 + ResNet50) and automated 3-day reporting down to 2 minutes.
- Data and financial analyst roles at Kingfisher (£10M supply chain) and Polystar.

Key Competencies

AI & ML	LLMs, RAG, GPU inference, vLLM, PyTorch, computer vision
Engineering	Python, TypeScript, SQL, Rust, React, Node.js
Data	Postgres, Spark, Neo4j, Palantir Foundry, vector search
Cloud & Security	AWS, GCP, Modal, Pulumi, Docker, CI/CD, SOC 2, ISO 27001, GDPR